

Chapter 6: Janapadas and Mahajanapadas

Textbook Exercise Solutions & Answers



1. Answer in one sentence:

Q1.) What is meant by janapada?

The small independent states that emerged in the post-Vedic period from roughly 1000 BCE to 600 BCE were known as janapadas.

Q2.) What is meant by mahajanapada?

Some janapadas gradually grew stronger, militarily powerful, and expanded their geographical territories; such large and dominant states came to be known as Mahajanapadas.

Q3.) Where was the first Buddhist council held?

The first Buddhist council (sangiti) was held at Rajgriha under the patronage of King Ajatashatru.

Q4.) Who introduced the system of standard weights and measures?

The rulers of the Nanda dynasty introduced the system of standard weights and measures.

2. Can you name the following?

Q1.) Some part of today's Maharashtra was occupied by this janapada.

Ashmaka (Assaka).

Q2.) This was an assembly of the senior citizens of a janapada.

Gana-parishad.

Q3.) This was the venue of discussion.

Santhagar.

Q4.) Gautam Buddha belonged to this janapada.

Shakya Republic.

Q5.) They had a four-column army.

The Nanda Kings (infantry, cavalry, chariots, and elephants).

3. Match the following:

Column A	Column B (Answer)
(1) Sangiti	(b) Parishad
(2) Dhanananda	(d) Nanda king
(3) Pataligram	(a) Ajatashatru

4. Make a table showing the various kingdoms in the Indian sub-continent and their capitals:

Kingdoms in the Indian Sub-continent	Capitals
Kosala	Shravasti
Vatsa	Kaushambi (Kosam)
Avanti	Ujjayani (Ujjain)
Magadha	Rajgriha (later Pataliputra)
Kashi	Varanasi
Vrijji	Vaishali
Malla	Kushinagar and Pava
Kuru	Hastinapur / Indraprastha
Panchala	Ahichhatra and Kampilya
Surasena	Mathura
Anga	Champa (Champanagari)
Ashmaka (Assaka)	Potana / Paudanya
Chedi	Shuktimati
Matsya	Viratnagar